

Nepal Witnesses Unprecedented Moment as Ex-Rapper Becomes PM
PG 3

India Script History with Stunning Victory to Capture T20 World Cup Crown
PG 8



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IITM Organized Mock Interview Session to Boost Students' Confidence and Career Readiness

IITM Bureau

The School of Mass Communication at IITM successfully organized a Mock Personal Interview Session for BAJMC students on March 17, 2026, with the objective of enhancing their confidence, communication abilities, and overall interview preparedness. The session was thoughtfully designed to simulate a real-world interview environment, offering students valuable practical exposure to professional recruitment and selection processes. The initiative formed part of the institution's continuous efforts to prepare students for future career opportunities and equip them with the essential soft skills required in the competitive media and com-

munication industry.

The mock interview session aimed to familiarize students with the expectations and standards followed by employers and industry professionals during recruitment. In today's highly competitive professional landscape, strong communication skills, confidence, and the ability to present oneself effectively are considered indispensable qualities. Keeping this in mind, the School of Mass Communication organized the session to help students develop these crucial competencies before stepping into the job market. During the session, students participated in one-on-one mock interviews conducted in a formal and professional setting. Each participant was given an opportu-



nity to experience the atmosphere of an actual interview, which included questions related to their academic background, subject knowledge, career aspirations, and current developments in the field of mass communication and journalism. The interviewers carefully assessed students on multiple parameters such as verbal communication skills, confidence level, body language, clarity of thought, subject awareness,

and professional presentation. One of the major highlights of the session was the presence of experienced industry professionals and experts, who conducted the interviews and interacted directly with the students. Their involvement added authenticity and practical relevance to the exercise. The experts posed realistic interview questions and observed the students' responses in terms of both content and delivery. This provided par-

ticipants with a clear understanding of the kinds of questions and expectations they are likely to encounter in actual placement interviews and professional selection processes. A significant component of the session was the constructive feedback provided to each student after the interview. The expert's shared valuable insights on individual performance, helping students identify both their strengths and areas that required

improvement. The feedback focused on aspects such as voice modulation, articulation, posture, eye contact, confidence, and overall professional demeanor. Students were also guided on how to structure their responses effectively, maintain composure under pressure, and present themselves confidently in formal interactions. The simulated interview setting proved highly beneficial in helping students overcome nervousness and stage fear. Many students often possess the required knowledge but struggle to express themselves effectively in an interview environment due to anxiety and lack of practice. By recreating a realistic interview experience, the session enabled

participants to confront these challenges and gradually build self-confidence. The exercise also helped students understand the importance of first impressions, etiquette, and positive body language in professional communication. Students actively engaged in the session and expressed appreciation for the opportunity to interact directly with experts from the media and communication field. Many participants described the experience as highly enriching and confidence-building. They noted that the mock interviews gave them a clearer perspective on how to prepare for real-life job interviews, internships, and placement drives. Faculty members of the School of Mass Communication

highlighted the importance of such practical skill-development sessions in bridging the gap between academic learning and industry requirements. They emphasized that while classroom teaching provides theoretical knowledge, professional success also depends heavily on communication skills, confidence, and presentation abilities. In fields such as journalism, public relations, advertising, and digital media, the ability to communicate effectively and present oneself professionally plays a crucial role in career growth. The faculty further noted that such initiatives contribute significantly to the holistic development of students by preparing them not only academically but also professionally.

IITM Hosts Skill-Oriented Workshop on Excel and MS Word for Students

IITM Bureau

The School of Mass Communication at IITM successfully organized a practical workshop on "Basics of Excel and MS Word" on March 18, 2026, with the objective of enhancing the digital, academic, and professional skills of students. The workshop was conducted by CA Rohit Kumar and was held in Lab No. 8 from 10:30 AM onwards. The session witnessed enthusiastic participation from students who were keen to strengthen their knowledge of essential computer applications widely used in academic institutions and professional workplaces. The workshop primarily focused on familiarizing students with two of the most important software tools Microsoft Excel and Microsoft Word. During the first part of the session, the trainer introduced students to the fundamentals of Microsoft Excel. The participants were guided through key features such as data entry, cell formatting, row and column man-

agement, use of basic formulas, and spreadsheet organization. Students were also introduced to simple calculations and formula-based operations that are commonly used for maintaining records, preparing data sheets, and performing basic analysis. Practical demonstrations on data organization and simple analytical techniques helped students understand how Excel can be effectively used for real-world tasks in media and administrative work. The second segment of the workshop focused on Microsoft Word, where students learned the basics of document creation and professional formatting. The session covered important features such as text styling, font customization, paragraph alignment, page layout, margin settings, header and footer insertion, and the use of bullets, numbering, and tables. Special emphasis was laid on creating well-structured and visually appealing documents, which are particularly useful for report writing, article



preparation, assignments, and content creation in the field of mass communication. A major highlight of the workshop was its hands-on learning approach. Students actively practiced the tasks demonstrated by the trainer, allowing them to gain practical exposure and confidence in using the software. The interactive nature of the session encouraged students to ask questions and clarify their doubts, making the workshop highly engaging and informative. Faculty members appreciated the initiative and emphasized the importance of such skill-based workshops in preparing students for the demands of the modern professional world. They noted that proficiency in tools like

Excel and MS Word is indispensable across diverse sectors such as media, journalism, business, education, and administration. Overall, the workshop proved to be highly beneficial, equipping students with valuable practical skills that will contribute significantly to their academic development and future career prospects. The workshop served as a valuable step towards building essential digital competencies among students, enabling them to perform academic and professional tasks more efficiently. Such initiatives reflect the institute's commitment to holistic learning and skill development, preparing students to meet the evolving demands of the modern workplace with confidence.

IITM Management Students Gain Industry Exposure During Visit to Mother Dairy

IITM Bureau

The Department of Management Studies at the Institute of Innovation in Technology and Management (IITM), in association with the Industry Institute Partnership Cell (IIPC), successfully organized an industrial visit to Mother Dairy on March 6, 2025, for 46 students of BBA Second Semester. The visit was aimed at providing practical exposure to students and bridging the gap between classroom learning and real-world industrial practices. During the visit, the students had the opportunity to explore the dairy processing plant and the logistics unit of Mother Dairy. They observed various stages involved in milk processing, packaging, quality control, storage, and distribution. The visit offered valuable firsthand insights into the functioning of one of India's leading dairy brands and helped students understand the operational aspects of production and supply chain management. A

major highlight of the visit was an interactive session conducted by Ms. Neha, Senior Executive at Mother Dairy. She shared detailed industry insights on dairy operations, inventory management, cold-chain logistics, and customer service strategies. The session proved highly engaging as students actively participated by asking questions related to business operations, management practices, and career opportunities in the sector. Ms. Neha patiently addressed their queries and encouraged them to connect theoretical knowledge with industry applications. The industrial visit served as an enriching learning experience for the students, enabling them to gain a deeper understanding of supply chain mechanisms and operational efficiency in the dairy sector. Such experiential learning initiatives play a crucial role in shaping managerial skills and enhancing students' professional outlook. Adding a delightful



touch to the visit, the students were treated to flavored milk and ice cream by Mother Dairy, making the day both educational and enjoyable. The Department of Management Studies expressed its commitment to organizing more such industry-oriented visits in the future to foster practical learning and industry exposure among students. To conclude, the industrial visit to Mother Dairy proved to be a highly impactful initiative that not only enhanced students' academic understanding but also inspired them to explore the dynamic opportunities within the dairy and FMCG sectors. The experience reinforced the importance of ex-

periential learning in management education by allowing students to witness real-time business operations and industry practices. Such initiatives strengthen the institute-industry interface and contribute significantly to the holistic development of future managers. The Department looks forward to continuing its efforts in providing meaningful exposure that equips students with the skills, confidence, and insights required to excel in their professional journeys. Overall, the visit left a lasting impression on the students, motivating them to apply their classroom knowledge more effectively in real-world business environments.

Government Notifies Landmark Gas Pipeline Order To Boost Infrastructure, Ease of Doing Business

IITM Bureau

On March 25, 2026, the Government of India notified the Natural Gas and Petroleum Products Distribution (Through Laying, Building, Operation and Expansion of Pipelines and Other Facilities) Order, 2026 under the Essential Commodities Act, 1955. Issued by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas and published in the Gazette of India, the order came into immediate effect, aiming to create a transparent, streamlined, and time-bound framework for pipeline infrastructure development across the country. The new policy addresses long-standing issues such as delays

PM Modi Inaugurates Kaynes Semiconductor Plant In Gujarat, Flags Push For Chip Ecosystem

IITM Bureau

Prime Minister Modi on March 31st 2026 inaugurated a semiconductor plant of Kaynes Technology in Sanand, Gujarat, marking the start of production at the facility and underlining India's push to build a domestic chip ecosystem. Noting the pace of developments in the sector, the Prime Minister referred to his visit to Sanand on February 28 for the start of production at the Micron facility, saying the back-to-back milestones reflect the momentum in India's semiconductor journey. The Kaynes facility will manufacture Intelligent Power Modules used in electric vehicles and in-

in approvals, regulatory uncertainty, and restricted land access. It introduces a uniform regulatory framework for laying, building, operating, and expanding pipelines, while standardising procedures, timelines, and charges. A key feature is the provision for time-bound approvals with deemed clearances, significantly reducing procedural delays and enhancing efficiency. To promote ease of doing business, the order harmonises rules across jurisdictions, removing fragmentation in permissions. It eliminates arbitrary levies, ensures cost predictability, and introduces clear compen-



sation and restoration mechanisms such as “dig and restore” and “dig and pay” to avoid disputes. Compliance requirements have also been simplified with well-defined documentation norms. The reform is expected to accelerate the expansion of pipeline infrastructure by enabling seamless access for authorised entities. It will support the rapid rollout of City

Gas Distribution networks, expansion of trunk pipelines, and improved last-mile connectivity for piped natural gas (PNG). The policy also focuses on consumer-centric service delivery by mandating time-bound PNG connections and improving service standards. It encourages a gradual shift from LPG to PNG where feasible, while allowing flexibility in areas

lacking infrastructure. Additionally, the order ensures that local bodies or private entities cannot unreasonably deny access for pipeline development. A transparent dispute resolution mechanism has been established to safeguard public interest. Overall, the reform is expected to strengthen energy security, boost investor confidence, support economic growth.

Four Semiconductor Plants To Be Ready In India This Year, Says Ashwini Vaishnaw

IITM Bureau

Indian Railways has rolled out a series of measures to manage heavy passenger rush at stations, including the creation of dedicated holding areas, access control systems, and enhanced surveillance, Union Minister for Railways Ashwini Vaishnaw said in the Rajya Sabha on March 28, 2026. In a written reply, the minister stated that permanent passenger holding areas will be developed at 76 identified stations to reduce congestion on platforms. These holding areas will be equipped with amenities such as seating, drinking water, toilets, ticketing facilities, information displays.

and security checks to handle peak-hour crowds. The holding area at New Delhi Railway Station has already been commissioned, featuring additional ticket counters, automatic ticket vending machines (AT-VMs), public announcement systems, electronic train information boards, CCTV surveillance, luggage scanners, door-frame metal detectors (DFMDs), improved lighting, power backup, RO drinking water, and separate toilets for men, women, and Divyangjans. “Similar facilities at other stations are in various stages of planning and execution,” he added. To streamline passen-

ger movement, complete access control will be implemented, allowing only passengers with confirmed reserved tickets direct entry to platforms, while those without tickets or on waiting lists will be accommodated in designated holding areas outside. Further, AI-enabled CCTV cameras are being installed at stations and adjoining areas for real-time monitoring and crowd management, while dedicated “war rooms” will be set up at major stations to ensure coordinated responses among departments. The Railways has also developed new designs for wider foot-over-bridges (FOBs).

conductor plant to be

Union Electronics and Information Technology Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on March 31st 2026, said four semiconductor plants are expected to be ready in India by 2026, as he outlined an accelerated roadmap for the sector following the inauguration of a new facility in Gujarat. In comments after Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the Kaynes Semicon's OSAT plant in Sanand, Vaishnaw said: "In 2026, four plants will be ready, and two plants in 2027. India's first fabrication unit will be ready in Dholera by 2028."

The Sanand unit is the country's second semi-



ty and cost; only then will we be able to sustain and make a position in the world." He said the semiconductor programme is being supported by the development of a wider ecosystem, including machinery, chemicals, gases and testing infrastructure.

315 universities, are contributing to chip design efforts. "Chips designed by these young engineers are being manufactured in a laboratory in Chandigarh," he said. He also said global firms, including Nvidia, AMD and Intel, are undertaking advanced chip design work in India. "Very complex 2-nanometre chips are being designed in India," he said, adding: "Our approach is design in India and make in India."

Centre releases over Rs 1,500 crore to boost rural local governance

IITM Bureau

The government on March 31, said it has released more than Rs 1,500 crore as the 15th Finance Commission grants to strengthen rural local governance in six states. The Centre sanctioned and released tied and untied grants during FY 2025–26 for Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs)/Rural Local Bodies (RLBs) in Telangana, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Uttarakhand, Mizoram and Meghalaya to further empower grassroots governance and enable need-based local development. For Telangana, Rs 247.94 crore has been released as

the first installment of untied grants of the financial year 2025-26. These funds are for eligible 12,600 Gram Panchayats (GPs) of the state. Similarly, for Uttarakhand, Rs. 91.31 crore has been released as second installment of untied grants of the financial year 2025-26, benefiting all 13 District Panchayats (DPs), 95 Block Panchayats (BPs) and eligible 7784 GPs. Further, Rs 1.84 crore of withheld portion of first instalment of untied grants for FY 2025-26 has also been released to additionally eligible 216 GPs, said the Ministry of Panchayati Raj. About Rs 315.61 crore has been

released for Rajasthan as second installment of untied grants of the financial year 2025-2026. These funds are for all 33 DPs, all 352 BPs and eligible 3857 GPs of the state. Further, Rs 12.57 crore of withheld portion of first instalment of untied grants for FY 2025-26 has also been released to additionally eligible 9 Zilla Panchayats and 13 BPs. Similarly, Meghalaya has received Rs 27 crore as 2nd installment of untied grants of the financial year 2021-22. These funds are for all 3 eligible Autonomous District Councils (Khasi, Garo, Jaintia) of the State.

Further, the Union Government has released 2nd installment of tied grants to Meghalaya amounting to Rs.22.20 crore. These funds are for all 816 eligible Village Councils including Autonomous District Council areas of the State, said the ministry. For Maharashtra, the Centre has released Rs 109.06 crore each as the withheld portions of the 1st and 2nd instalments of tied grants, benefiting an additional 12 eligible DPs and 125 BPs. In addition, Maharashtra has also received Rs 116.97 crore as the withheld portion of the 1st instalment for FY 2024-25.

Nalanda Stampede: PM Modi Expresses Distress, Announces Financial Aid

IITM Bureau

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on March 31st 2026, expressed grief over the loss of lives in the tragic Nalanda stampede and announced financial assistance for the families of the deceased. A stampede broke out during prayers at Mata Sheetla Temple in Nalanda leaving seven people dead and one seriously injured, police confirmed. In a post on X, the Prime Minister's Office (PMO) said, "The mishap in Nalanda district, Bihar, is deeply painful. I extend my condolences to those

who have lost their loved ones. Prayers for the speedy recovery of those injured.” “An ex-gratia of Rs. 2 lakh from PMNRF would be given to the next of kin of each deceased. The injured would be given Rs. 50,000,” the statement added. Meanwhile, Bihar Deputy Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary expressed grief over the loss of lives and assured that all the necessary assistance would be provided to those affected. In a post on X, Choudhary said, “The tragic stampede incident at the Mata Sheetla Temple in Nalanda is extreme-



ly heartbreaking. I express my condolences to the families of all the devotees who lost their lives and were injured in this accident." "The government is providing every possible assistance and relief to the affected families. Arrangements have been made for the proper treatment of the injured," he said. "May God grant peace to the departed souls and provide strength to the grieving fami-

lies during this hour of sorrow. I pray for the swift recovery of the injured,” the Deputy Chief Minister added. The incident occurred at the Mata Sheetla Temple in the Deepnagar police station area. Upon learning about the incident, police officials, together with residents, hurried to the location and initiated relief and rescue efforts. Rescue officials reached the site and are carrying out relief operations. Injured individuals are being sent to the nearest hospital for treatment. Police are on the site and are trying to determine the cause of the stampede.

Nepal Witnesses Unprecedented Moment as Ex-Rapper Becomes PM

IITM Bureau

Rapper-turned-politician Balendra Shah has been sworn in as Nepal’s prime minister after a landslide victory in the country’s first election since last year’s youth-led protests. The 35-year-old’s rise marks an important shift in Nepali politics. His promise of change resonated with an electorate that was angry at corruption, nepotism and elite rule. Before taking office on Friday (March 27 2026), Shah, popularly known as Balen, released a song filled with optimism about Nepal’s future. “Undivided Nepali, this time history is being made,” he rapped in a track that garnered more than two million views



within hours of its release. The song harks back to his roots in the underground rap scene, where he used music to call out corruption and other social problems in Nepal. After just three years as mayor of the capital Kathmandu, Shah teamed up with the Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP) Kathmandu, and is as its prime-ministerial candidate, scoring a decisive victory in general elections this

month. His supporters see him as a symbol of change and a break from the failings of Nepal’s old guard. But some question whether the four-year-old RSP is capable of making good on its bold pledges. The rebellious rapper Shah was born in 1990 in Naradevi, Kathmandu, and is his parents’ youngest son. His father is an Ayurvedic practitioner and his mother stayed

at home to bring up the family. Shah is married and lives with his wife and daughter. After leaving school he graduated with engineering degrees in Kathmandu and later in the southern Indian state of Karnataka. In 2013, he shot to fame after winning a popular rap battle in Nepal, with sharp verses that carried the frustration of a generation that felt suppressed and aban-

doned. Shah went on to release several popular songs which criticised corruption and social inequality in the Himalayan nation. He cut a distinctive figure in the music videos with his trademark square black sunglasses, a black blazer and black trousers. One of his best-known hits, Balidan, has amassed 14m views on YouTube. In 2022, the political newbie won Kathmandu’s mayoral race by a landslide as an independent candidate, triumphing over parties which had dominated elections for decades. His tenure as mayor was marked by efforts to clean up the city, preserve indigenous heritage, and a crack-down on corruption.

PM Modi Discusses West Asia Situation With Saudi Crown Prince, Stresses Secure Shipping Routes

IITM Bureau

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday held a telephonic conversation with Saudi Arabia’s Crown Prince and Prime Minister, Mohammed bin Salman, to discuss the rapidly escalating situation in West Asia and its broader regional and global implications. The dialogue comes at a time of heightened tensions in the region, particularly concerning security, energy stability, and maritime safety. Sharing details of the conversation on X, the Prime Minister stated that both leaders exchanged views on the



ongoing conflict and emphasized the urgent need for de-escalation. He reiterated India’s strong condemnation of attacks targeting critical energy infrastructure in the region, underlining the importance of safeguarding such assets for global economic stability. Given that West Asia plays a vital role in the world’s energy supply, any disruption poses significant risks not only to regional countries but also to the global economy. Both leaders also highlighted the necessity of ensuring freedom of navigation, especially along key international shipping routes. They agreed that maintaining open, secure, and

uninterrupted shipping lines is crucial for global trade and energy transportation. Any threats to maritime security could have far-reaching consequences, affecting supply chains and increasing economic uncertainty worldwide. In addition to strategic and security concerns, Prime Minister Modi expressed appreciation for Saudi Arabia’s continued support toward the welfare of the Indian community residing in the Kingdom. The Indian diaspora in Saudi Arabia plays a significant role in strengthening bilateral ties, and their well-being remains a priority

for the Indian government. The conversation reflects the strong and evolving partnership between India and Saudi Arabia, as both nations continue to engage closely on regional stability, economic cooperation, and the safety of their people. Both sides also reaffirmed their commitment to strengthening diplomatic dialogue, enhancing economic partnerships, promoting energy collaboration, and working together on global platforms to address shared challenges, including climate change, sustainable development, and long-term regional peace and prosperity.

Iran’s Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, who led the Islamic Republic since 1989, is dead at 86

IITM Bureau

Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, who assembled theocratic power in Iran over the decades as its top leader and sought to turn it into a regional powerhouse, bringing it into confrontation with Israel and the United States over its nuclear program while crushing democracy protests, has been killed in U.S. and Israeli strikes. Iranian state media reported the death early Sunday (March 1 2026), after a major attack launched by Israel and the United States. U.S. President Donald Trump said hours earlier that Khamenei had been killed in the joint operation. Khamenei dramati-



cally remolded the Islamic Republic since he took the reins after the death of Ayatollah Ruhollah Khomeini in 1989. Khomeini was the fiery, charismatic ideologue who led the overthrow of the shah and installed rule by Shiite Muslim clerics tasked with spreading religious purity. It fell to Khamenei, a stodgier figure with weaker religious credentials and a leaden demean-

or, to turn that revolutionary vision into a state establishment. He ended up ruling far longer than Khomeini. He greatly expanded the Shiite clerical class and built the paramilitary Revolutionary Guard into the most important body underpinning his rule. The Guard became a military and business behemoth, the country’s most elite force and head of its ballistic

missile arsenal, with hands across Iran’s economic sectors. But the strains became harder to contain. Political repression and the faltering economy fueled successively bigger waves of mass protests. Anger over the 2022 death of Mahsa Amini, detained for not wearing her mandatory headscarf properly, escalated into demonstrations against social restrictions. In early January, hundreds of thousands marched in cities across the country, many chanting, “Death to Khamenei.” Khamenei responded with the deadliest crackdown seen in nearly 50 years of clerical rule

IITM Bureau

France will host the leaders of India, South Korea, Brazil and Kenya at the G7 leaders’ summit in Evian-Bains from June 15 to 17, in a move aimed at broadening international support for addressing global economic imbalances, Paris said on March 26, 2026. According to French officials, the summit’s central objective is to build consensus on preventing what they described as a “massive financial crisis.” France is expected to push for major economic reforms, including urging China to boost domestic demand and reduce its destabilising

U.S. not ready for deal with Iran, might hit Kharg ‘for fun’: Trump

IITM Bureau

Donald Trump warned that he is not ready to seek a deal to end the war with Iran, as U.S. ally Israel launched a new wave of strikes on Sunday (March 15, 2026) and Tehran’s Revolutionary Guards threatened to hunt down and kill the Israeli leader. In an interview with NBC News, Trump stated that although Iran appears willing to negotiate, the United States is in no hurry to reach a settlement. He emphasized that Washington would continue to press for more favorable terms before considering any deal. The President’s comments suggest a strategic shift toward prolonged pres-

sure rather than immediate diplomacy. Adding to the seriousness of the situation, Trump made a controversial remark about the possibility of targeting Iran’s key oil facility on Kharg Island. He suggested that the U.S. might consider striking the site again; reportedly stating it could happen “just for fun,” a comment that has drawn criticism and raised concerns about further escalation in the region. Meanwhile, Israel, a key U.S. ally, launched a fresh wave of airstrikes on Sunday, targeting what is described as strategic Iranian positions. In response, Iran’s Revolutionary Guards issued strong warnings,

threatening retaliation and vowing to pursue Israeli leadership. The developments indicate a sharp deterioration in regional stability, with fears growing over a wider conflict involving multiple nations. Analysts warn that continued escalation could disrupt global energy markets and increase geopolitical uncertainty. As tensions mount, the international community has called for restraint and renewed diplomatic efforts to prevent the situation from spiraling into a larger conflict. However, with both sides maintaining aggressive postures, prospects for immediate de-escalation appear uncertain.

The United Nations Needs a Secretary-General of Courage, Not Convenience

IITM Bureau

The United Nations was not founded to be comfortable; it was founded to be necessary. Created in the aftermath of catastrophe, its purpose was clear: to maintain international peace and security, to uphold international law, to defend human rights and to promote human dignity and development. The office of the Secretary-General was never intended to be merely administrative. It was intended to be moral, political and, when necessary, courageous. This was stated by Naïma Abdellaoui (Geneva)

on March 30, 2026. As member states consider the appointment of the next Secretary-General, they face a decision that will shape not only the future of the United Nations, but also its credibility. The world today does not suffer from a surplus of institutions; it suffers from a shortage of trust in them. The next Secretary-General must therefore be more than a careful manager of bureaucracy. The world needs a leader with vision, independence and integrity a leader willing to uphold the Charter even when doing so is inconvenient to pow-

erful member states. Too often, the selection process produces a candidate who is acceptable to everyone precisely because they are unlikely to seriously challenge anyone. This may be politically expedient, but it is strategically short-sighted. An overly cautious Secretary-General may preserve short-term diplomatic comfort while presiding over long-term institutional decline. The United Nations does not need a figure who simply reflects the balance of power within the Security Council; it needs a figure who reflects the principles of the Charter.

G7 Leaders’ June Summit to Host India, South Korea, Brazil and Kenya, Not China

IITM Bureau

France will host the leaders of India, South Korea, Brazil and Kenya at the G7 leaders’ summit in Evian-Bains from June 15 to 17, in a move aimed at broadening international support for addressing global economic imbalances, Paris said on March 26, 2026. According to French officials, the summit’s central objective is to build consensus on preventing what they described as a “massive financial crisis.” France is expected to push for major economic reforms, including urging China to boost domestic demand and reduce its destabilising

export-driven growth model. At the same time, Paris wants the United States to rein in its fiscal deficits, while encouraging Europe to increase production and reduce excessive savings. However, these long-term economic ambitions may be overshadowed by pressing geopolitical concerns. The summit will take place amid an ongoing energy shock triggered by the conflict involving the United States, Israel and Iran, which has already unsettled global markets and raised concerns over fuel prices and supply chains. “We do not know where the Iran crisis will be by June,” an adviser to



French President Emmanuel Macron said, adding that regardless of how the situation evolves, the G7 will need to address its energy and economic consequences. Notably, China will not attend the summit. French officials said Beijing continues to question the legitimacy of the G7, often describing it as a “club of rich countries.” While France had reportedly explored the possibility of inviting China, it now plans to engage

with Beijing through separate diplomatic channels. The invited nations - India, South Korea, Brazil and Kenya—have been described by French officials as democracies and market economies committed to international cooperation. Meanwhile, uncertainty also surrounds the participation of U.S. President Donald Trump, whose tariff threats and policy decisions have rattled allies and global markets.

SSD and RAM Prices Rise Amid Global Shortage, India Feels the Impact

Mr. Shinjan Chatterjee

There is growing concern over the sharp rise in the prices of SSDs (Solid State Drives) and RAM (Random Access Memory), with consumers across India increasingly feeling the financial impact. This surge in prices is primarily driven by a global shortage of memory chips, which has disrupted supply chains and affected the availability of essential computing components. In recent years, the demand for memory chips has increased significantly, largely due to the rapid expansion of artificial intelligence (AI) technologies. Major global technology companies are investing heavily in AI-powered data centers, which require massive amounts of

AAP removes Chadha, sparks debate on discipline and dissent AAP

Dr. Nivedita Sharma

The decision by the Aam Aadmi Party to remove Raghav Chadha from the post of Deputy Leader in the Rajya Sabha marks a significant moment in the party's internal trajectory. While the move has been officially linked to concerns over parliamentary engagement and alignment with party positions, the sharp rebuttal from Chadha has ensured that the issue extends beyond a routine organisational reshuffle. At the heart of the matter lies a familiar tension in political parties: the balance between discipline and dissent. For a party that

The Gilded Facade: Decoding India's Hosting v/s Welfare Paradox

Mr. Suchivrat Arya

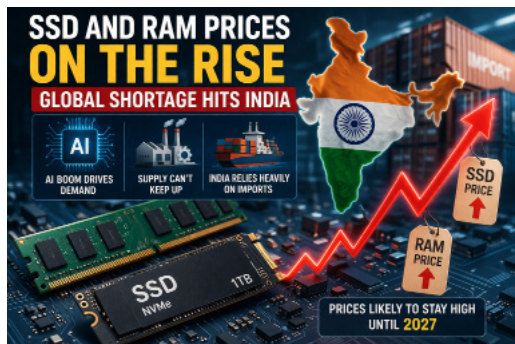
As India aggressively manoeuvres for the 2036 Olympic bid, the national sporting discourse has hit a friction point. The Union Budget 2026-27 recently allocated a record 4,479.88 crore to the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports an 18% jump that signals a “Viksit Bharat” (Developed India) ambition.

However, beneath the gleaming architectural renders of Ahmedabad’s proposed Olympic masterplan lies a biting paradox: Can a nation justify spending billions on a three-week global spectacle while its primary talent

high-performance memory. These companies often purchase memory chips in bulk, securing supply well in advance and leaving limited stock available for the general market. At the same time, the supply of memory chips has not been able to keep pace with this rising demand. The manufacturing of SSDs and RAM is dominated by a small number of global companies, and expanding production capacity is both time-consuming and capital-intensive. As a result, the imbalance between supply and demand continues to push prices upward. India, being heavily dependent on imports for these components, is particularly vulnerable to such global fluctuations. Any increase in international prices

has consistently projected itself as a champion of transparency and internal democracy, the optics of sidelining a prominent and articulate leader raise questions. Party sources cite absenteeism and limited participation in key debates, suggesting a need to enforce accountability. If true, such concerns are not trivial, parliamentary performance is central to the credibility of any elected representative. However, Chadha's categorical denial and his assertion that the move is a "planned attempt" to marginalise him introduce a competing narrative. His strong words signal not

pipeline remains financially and physically fragile? The logic behind the hosting frenzy is rooted in “Legacy Infrastructure.” Proponents argue that the Olympic bid acts as a catalyst for urban renewal and national pride. The 2026 budget already earmarks 500 crore for sports goods manufacturing and significant sums for “Mera Yuva Bharat” skill-building, aiming to turn India into a global sports hub. The vision is to move from a “one-off spike” to a 10-year build-out of world-class facilities. This paradox is further complicated by



is quickly reflected in the domestic market, making electronic devices more expensive for Indian consumers. The impact is already visible in the rising prices of laptops, personal computers, and smartphones. In some cases, manufacturers are offering devices with reduced RAM or storage configurations to maintain affordability. Industry experts suggest that this is not a short-term issue. The current trend is expected to continue until at least 2027.

just personal grievance but also hint at deeper unease within the party structure. In politics, perception often carries as much weight as fact, and the perception of internal discord can quickly overshadow organisational intent. The episode also invites speculation about the party's evolving political calculus. Observers have pointed to possible undercurrents linked to its positioning in key states such as Punjab, where leadership dynamics remain crucial. While no official confirmation supports these claims, such interpretations underline how internal decisions are rarely

a systemic “Nutrition Gap” and the unique challenges of the Indian climate. Despite the record budget, India’s per-capita spending on athlete welfare remains a fraction of that seen in leading sporting nations, often forcing rural athletes to use their meagre training stipends to support their families’ basic survival rather than their own peak physical conditioning. Simultaneously, a new environmental crisis has emerged where the construction of multi-billion-dollar open-air arenas coincides with worsening seasonal smog. In early 2026, the irony was laid bare as inter-



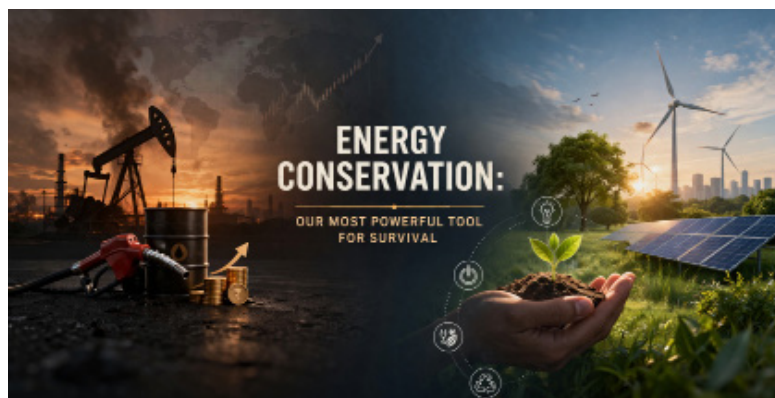
viewed in isolation, especially in a party navigating both governance and expansion. More broadly, the development underscores the challenges faced by relatively young political formations as they mature. The transition from activist roots to institutional politics often brings with it stricter expectations of discipline, but also tests the space available for individual expression. How

national players opted to pay fines rather than compete in the hazardous air of New Delhi, highlighting a grim reality: the nation is building world-class stages for a global audience while its own athletes are frequently discouraged from training outdoors due to medical risks. Ultimately, the tension between hosting glory and athlete welfare is exacerbated by the constitutional “State vs. Center” disconnect. Because sports is a State subject, the Central Government’s massive investments in “Olympic Readiness” often fail to reach the grassroots level where school playgrounds

nological demands. In the long term, this situation also highlights the urgent need for countries like India to strengthen their domestic semiconductor manufacturing capabilities. Initiatives such as Semicon India Programme and the broader push under Make in India aim to reduce dependence on imports and build a resilient electronics ecosystem. By investing in local production, research, and supply chain infrastructure, India can better safeguard itself against global disruptions and price volatility. While such developments will take time to materialize, they represent a crucial step toward ensuring technological self-reliance and stabilizing costs for consumers in the future.

The Fight for Survival Begins with Energy Conservation

Dr. Bal Krishna Mishra



Energy today is not merely a driver of development; it has become a fundamental question of survival. In the backdrop of renewed geopolitical tensions involving Iran, the United States, and Israel, global energy markets have once again been shaken. Fluctuating oil and gas prices, supply chain disruptions, and excessive dependence on limited resources have exposed the fragility of modern civilization. The situation compels us to rethink whether our progress rests on unstable foundations.

In such a scenario, energy conservation emerges not just as an option but as the most practical, economical, and immediate solution. Energy powers everything from industries and transportation to digital systems and household needs. Ironically, the same force that fuels development is now becoming a source of crisis. According to the United Nations' Energy Progress Report 2024, global energy demand is projected to rise by nearly 25% in the coming decade, while fossil fuel reserves continue to deplete. If unchecked, this imbalance could lead to economic instability, social unrest, and even international conflicts.

The current global context further highlights this urgency. Ongoing conflicts in West Asia have made crude oil prices highly volatile, raising concerns over supply security. For countries like India, which imports more than 85% of its crude oil requirements, such instability has direct economic consequences. Rising fuel prices not only increase transportation costs but also trigger inflation across sectors, including food and construction. Thus, energy conservation becomes essential not only for environmental sustainability but also for economic resilience. India's rapidly growing economy adds another layer of complexity. The India Energy Outlook 2024 by the International Energy Agency suggests that India will become one of the largest energy consumers by 2030. Balancing economic growth with environmental sustainability will be challenging unless energy consumption patterns are optimized. Recognizing this, India has already taken significant steps. Initiatives like the UJALA scheme and the Energy Conservation Act demonstrate how small interventions can yield substantial results. The distribution of over 360 million LED bulbs, leading to savings of nearly 48 billion units of electricity, is a testament to the power of policy combined with public participation.

One of the greatest advantages of energy conservation is its simplicity. It does not necessarily demand advanced technology or heavy investments. Small behavioral changes such as switching off unused lights, using energy-efficient appliances, limiting air conditioner usage, and opting for public transport can collectively make a significant difference. If every household in India conserves even one unit of electricity daily, the cumulative impact would be transformative. Energy conservation is also deeply interconnected with water, environment, and health. Energy production consumes vast quantities of water, meaning that wastage of water indirectly results in energy loss. Excessive energy consumption further increases carbon emissions, contributing to climate change and global warming. As the world strives to limit temperature rise to 1.5°C, conservation stands out as one of the most effective strategies. Urbanization and industrialization have significantly increased energy demand. The rise of high-rise buildings, air conditioning systems, and vehicles has intensified consumption. Promoting green buildings, adopting solar energy, and improving public transportation can reduce electricity usage by 30–40%. Similarly, enhancing energy efficiency in industries can lower production costs and improve competitiveness.

India today stands at a crucial juncture. By integrating energy conservation with renewable energy and technological innovation, it can set a global example of sustainable development. The energy crisis is not merely about scarcity of resources; it is also about human behavior. By treating energy as a precious resource and using it wisely, we can secure a stable and prosperous future. In essence, energy conservation is not a complex science but a simple way of life and perhaps our most powerful tool for survival.

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Jan Samarth Portal Processes Over 1 Lakh Crore In Loan Applications

IITM Bureau

The government's Jan Samarth portal has processed more than 41 lakh loan applications amounting to 1,06,306 crore since its launch, with banks granting digital approvals to over 35 lakh beneficiaries worth 84,365.55 crore, according to official data released on Monday (March 30th 2026). Launched on June 6, 2022, the Jan Samarth portal serves as a national platform for credit-linked government schemes, aimed at improving access to institutional credit and streamlining the loan application process through a digital interface.

The portal currently hosts 15 credit-linked schemes spanning sectors such as ag-

riculture, renewable energy, business, livelihoods and housing. It integrates multiple stakeholders, including beneficiaries, financial institutions and government agencies, to enable seamless credit delivery. As of March 20, 2026, a total of 254 lending institutions have been onboarded on the platform. These include 12 public sector banks, 20 private sector banks, 28 regional rural banks, 173 district central cooperative banks, 15 non-banking financial companies and six small finance banks. Officials said the portal functions as a digital marketplace, offering a single-window facility for applying to multiple schemes. It allows users to check eligibility, receive in-principle



sanction and track applications in real time without the need for repeated visits to bank branches. The platform uses advanced analytics and integrates with various databases, including those of the Income Tax Department, GST network, UIDAI and credit bureaus, to enable faster processing and verification of applications. Applicants can complete the process in four steps checking eligibility, submitting

applications online, selecting lenders and receiving digital approvals, and tracking the application status. The portal is available in eight languages and also provides assisted access through banking correspondents. It can be accessed via a dedicated website and mobile applications on both Android and iOS platforms. The government said the initiative is aimed at promoting inclusive growth by ensuring that individu-

als and businesses can easily access appropriate credit schemes. More central and state government schemes are expected to be integrated into the platform in the coming period. The Jan Samarth portal brings together schemes such as the Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana, Kisan Credit Card, PM SVANidhi, PMEGP and rooftop solar financing under a unified digital framework to enhance ease of doing business and financial inclusion.

The Jan Samarth portal has strengthened financial inclusion by simplifying access to loans through a unified digital system. By integrating schemes it ensures faster approvals, transparency, and wider reach of institutional credit across sectors.

Cabinet approves ₹28,840 crore Modified UDAN scheme; to develop 100 airports, 200 helipads

IITM Bureau

The cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, on 25 March, approved the launch and implementation of the Regional Connectivity Scheme (RCS)-Modified Ude Desh ka Aam Naagrik (UDAN) for 10 years, with a total outlay of ₹28,840 crore backed by government budgetary support. Under the scheme, which will be in place from financial year (FY) 2026-27 to FY 2035-36, the government will develop 100 airports/airstrips. "Under the Modified UDAN Scheme, it is proposed to develop 100 airports from existing unserved airstrips to enhance regional connectivity,

in line with the Viksit Bharat 2047 vision of infrastructure expansion and transforming India into a globally competitive aviation ecosystem, with a total outlay of ₹12,159 crore over the next eight years," a statement issued by the government read. "It will be a boost to economic growth, trade and tourism in tier-2 and tier-3 cities, support affordable air travel for common citizens, (help in) improved emergency response and healthcare access in remote and hilly regions, greater viability and sustainability for regional aerodromes and airline operators, 2024, UDAN 5.4 in August 2024, and UDAN 5.5 was launched in February last year.

Parliament Approves Finance Bill; Budget 2026-27 Gets Legislative Nod

IITM Bureau

The Parliament on March 27, approved the Finance Bill 2026 with the Rajya Sabha returning it to the Lok Sabha by a voice vote, completing the legislative process to provide the legal backing for the proposals of the Union Budget 2026-27 to kick in during the new financial year beginning from April 1. The Lok Sabha passed the bill on March 25, along with 32 amendments. The Rajya Sabha returned the bill after a brief discussion, and Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman's reply to questions raised by Members of Parliament on her budget proposals. The Union Budget 2026-27 outlined a total expenditure of Rs 53.47



lakh crore, an increase of 7.7 per cent over the current financial year ending on March 31. The budget proposes a capital expenditure of Rs 12.2 lakh crore for big-ticket infrastructure projects to boost growth and jobs in the economy. This represents an increase of 2.2 lakh crore over the corresponding figure of the previous fiscal year. The Finance Minister said that an Infrastructure Risk Development Fund would

be set up to accelerate the development of big projects.

She has also projected a further reduction in the fiscal deficit to 4.3 per cent of GDP for 2026-27 as the government continues on the path of fiscal consolidation to ensure economic growth with stability. The Finance Minister said that the target reflects a balance between supporting economic momentum and keeping public finances stable. The fis-

cal deficit represents the gap between the government's total expenditure and its total revenue. She said that the government would go for net borrowing of Rs 11.7 lakh crore in FY27 from dated securities to fund its fiscal deficit, while the gross market borrowing is pegged at Rs 17.2 lakh crore. The Finance Minister said the Budget proposes to deliver a powerful push to infrastructure, including highways, ports, railways and power projects, scale up manufacturing in 7 strategic sectors and create champion MSMEs. She further stated that the government has maintained fiscal prudence and monetary stability whilst maintaining a strong thrust on public investments.

RBI Moves To Protect Customers In Online Fraud Cases, Seeks Public Feedback

IITM Bureau

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has proposed a revised framework to address unauthorised electronic banking transactions, introducing a compensation mechanism for small-value fraud cases and strengthening safeguards against cyber threats. The updated instructions, released for public and stakeholder consultation on March 6, 2026, come amid rapid growth in digital payments and increasing instances of cyber fraud. The proposed framework builds upon the exist-

ing 2017 guidelines on limiting customer liability in unauthorised transactions. As part of efforts to enhance fraud detection and prevention, the Indian Digital Payment Intelligence Corporation (IDPIC) has been set up as a Section 8 company under the Companies Act, 2013. Incorporated in October 2025, the entity will focus on real-time monitoring and analysis of fraud in the digital payments ecosystem using Artificial Intelligence (AI), Machine Learning (ML), and Big Data Analytics. The RBI has also de-

ployed "MuleHunter.AI", an AI-driven solution designed to identify mule accounts used for layering and diverting funds in cyber fraud cases. The system is currently operational in 26 banks and is being expanded further. In addition, banks have been directed to strengthen internal systems, deploy real-time transaction monitoring tools, and leverage advanced analytics to detect suspicious patterns and networks linked to fraudulent activities. To curb the misuse of banking channels, the central bank has



issued advisories outlining specific measures for prevention and early detection of cyber-enabled frauds, including stricter monitoring of accounts suspected to be used as money mules. Alongside regulatory measures, efforts to improve financial awareness among citizens are also being

No Fuel Shortage, No Lockdown: Govt Moves To Secure Energy Supply Amid West Asia Crisis

IITM Bureau

The government on Friday (March 27 2026) dismissed rumors of a possible lockdown and reassured citizens that there is no shortage of petrol, diesel or LPG across the country, even as tensions in West Asia continue to disrupt global energy markets. In an inter-ministerial briefing, officials emphasized that supply chains remain fully operational and adequate fuel stocks are being maintained, urging the public to avoid panic buying and not fall prey to misinformation circulating on social media. Amid a sharp surge in global crude oil prices triggered by the ongoing crisis, the government announced a



reduction of ₹10 per litre in excise duty on petrol and diesel to shield consumers from rising costs. At the same time, export duties have been imposed on diesel (₹21.5 per litre) and aviation turbine fuel (₹29.5 per litre) to prioritise domestic availability. Domestic refiners have also been directed to divert 50 per cent of exported petrol and 30 per cent of exported diesel to the local market, ensuring uninterrupted supply. Officials said all refineries are operating at high capacity, with sufficient crude inventories in place. Retail fuel outlets across the country are functioning normally, although isolated instances of panic buying were reported due to rumors. The government reiterated that there is no cause for concern, adding that enforcement agencies are actively cracking down on hoarding and black

Sensex, Nifty Extend Gains On Softer Oil Prices, Global Cues

IITM Bureau

Indian stock markets ended higher for the second straight session on Wednesday (March 25 2026), supported by easing oil prices and positive global cues. Investor sentiment improved after US President Donald Trump reiterated that talks are ongoing to bring an end to the conflict in the Middle East. Indian stock markets ended on a strong note for the second consecutive session on Wednesday, buoyed by easing global crude oil prices and positive international cues. Im-

proved investor sentiment followed remarks by former U.S. President Donald Trump, who indicated that negotiations were underway to bring an end to the ongoing conflict in the Middle East. Benchmark indices recorded significant gains during the trading session. The Nifty surged by 1.72 per cent, or 392.70 points, to close at 23,306.45. Meanwhile, the Sensex advanced 1.63 per cent, gaining 1,205 points to settle at 75,273.45. The rally reflected renewed confidence among investors amid hopes of

marketing, with over 3,000 raids conducted and more than 1,500 LPG cylinders seized. To further stabilise supply, domestic LPG production has been increased by 40 per cent, while the allocation of commercial LPG has been raised to 70 per cent of pre-crisis levels. Priority is being given to key sectors such as hospitality, food processing, and critical industries. Additionally, over 10,500 new PNG connections were issued across 110 areas in a single day, as part of efforts to promote alternative fuel adoption and reduce dependence on LPG. City Gas Distribution companies have been directed to prioritise PNG connections for essential institutions. geopolitical stability and lower energy costs. Despite the overall positive trend, some stocks lagged behind. Companies such as Tech Mahindra, Power Grid, and TCS were among the major losers on the Sensex. On the other hand, Bajaj Finance, Titan, IndiGo, Trent, and Mahindra & Mahindra emerged as top gainers, contributing significantly to the market's upward movement. Broader markets outperformed the benchmark indices, indicating strong participation across segments.

Government Regulates Prices Of Life-Saving Drugs Through Key Health Schemes: Anupriya Patel

IITM Bureau

The Government on Friday (March 20 2026) said that the prices of life-saving drugs in India are regulated under the Drugs (Prices Control) Order (DPCO), 2013, to ensure affordability and accessibility for the public. In a written reply in the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Chemicals and Fertilizers Anupriya Patel stated that the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) fixes ceiling prices of medicines listed under Schedule-I of the DPCO, which is based on the National List of Essential Medicines. The authority also determines retail prices for new drugs and ensures

that manufacturers of non-scheduled formulations do not increase the maximum retail price by more than 10 per cent annually. She added that NPPA can intervene in extraordinary circumstances in public interest to regulate drug prices, while instances of overcharging are addressed as per provisions of the DPCO. Patel clarified that no fixed criteria currently exist for maintaining buffer stocks of essential medicines. However, NPPA continuously monitors the availability of drugs and takes corrective action when shortages are reported through various channels, including state drug controllers and public



grievance platforms. Highlighting broader efforts to improve access to affordable healthcare, the minister outlined several initiatives. Under the Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Janaushadhi Pariyojana, Janaushadhi Kendras provide quality generic medicines at prices 50 to 80 per cent lower than branded alternatives. More than 18,646 Janausadhi Kendras are operational across the country as of February

28, 2026. Additionally, the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY) offers health insurance coverage up to ₹5 lakh annually to eligible families for secondary and tertiary care, including the cost of medicines. The Minister said that the government is also ensuring free access to essential drugs at public health facilities under the National Health Mission's Free Drugs Service Initiative. Other

er measures include the AMRIT initiative, which provides medicines and medical consumables at discounted rates through dedicated pharmacy outlets in hospitals. Financial assistance is also extended to economically weaker sections through schemes such as the Rashtriya Arogya Nidhi and the Health Minister's Discretionary Grant, particularly for treatment of life-threatening diseases. The minister noted that the review of the DPCO, 2013 is an ongoing process, undertaken periodically to strengthen enforcement and ensure that essential medicines remain available to the public at affordable prices.

Govt Expands Tribal Healthcare Access Under National Health Mission With Relaxed Norms

IITM Bureau

The Centre has intensified efforts to strengthen healthcare delivery in tribal and remote regions through targeted interventions under the National Health Mission (NHM), aiming to improve access, infrastructure, and service quality. In a written reply in the Lok Sabha on Monday (23 March 2026), Union Minister of State for Health and Family Welfare Prataprao Jadhav said the Centre is providing both technical and financial support to states and Union Territories to enhance healthcare systems, particularly in tribal-dominated districts. To boost last-mile healthcare delivery, the government has re-

laxed key NHM norms for tribal, hilly, and hard-to-reach areas. The population criteria for setting up Sub Health Centres, Primary Health Centres, and Community Health Centres have been reduced, while provisions for deploying frontline workers have been expanded. Each habitation can now have an Accredited Social Health Activist, improving grassroots outreach. Additionally, the number of Mobile Medical Units permitted in such areas has been increased. Under NHM, up to four MMUs per district are allowed, while initiatives like the Pradhan Mantri Janjati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyan enable up to ten

MMUs in districts with Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups. Mobile Medical Units continue to play a crucial role in delivering healthcare services to remote and underserved populations. As per official data, a total of 1,453 MMUs are currently operational across the country, including those deployed under NHM and related tribal welfare initiatives. These units provide essential medical services in difficult terrains where access to fixed health facilities remains limited. The government has also expanded primary healthcare infrastructure through the establishment of Ayushman Arogya Mandirs (AAMs).

Argentina Formally Withdraws From World Health Organization

IITM Bureau

Argentina has formally withdrawn from the World Health Organization (WHO), Foreign Minister Pablo Quirno confirmed. In a social media post on Tuesday (March 18, 2026), Quirno said the country had communicated its decision through a formal note to the United Nations Secretary-General on March 17, 2025. In line with the Vienna Convention on the Law of Treaties, the withdrawal has now taken effect one year after the notification. “Our country will continue to promote international cooperation in health through bilateral agreements and regional forums, while fully safeguarding its sovereignty and decision-making capacity in health pol-

icy,” Quirno said. The Argentine government had first announced its intention to withdraw from the WHO in February 2025. Presidential spokesperson Manuel Adorni had stated at the time that President Javier Milei had instructed the foreign ministry to exit the UN specialised agency. Adorni had said the move would give Argentina greater flexibility to design health policies suited to national priorities, while also improving the availability of resources and reinforcing the country’s sovereignty in health matters. Officials maintained that Argentina does not rely on WHO funding for its health programmes, arguing that the withdrawal would not impact the quality of healthcare ser-



vices. The government also rejected concerns raised on social media, asserting that the decision would allow the country to independently shape its public health strategies without external interference. When asked about the possibility of withdrawing from other international organizations, Adorni had said no decision had been taken, but emphasized the administration's broader goal of making Argentina "freer" in its policy choices. The move marks a significant shift in Argentina's engagement

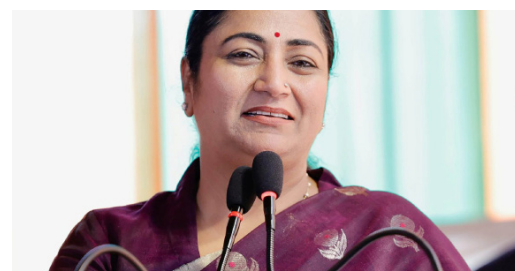
with global health institutions, even as it signals continued cooperation through bilateral and regional frameworks. The development is likely to spark debate among global health experts and policymakers regarding the implications of reduced multilateral engagement. It may also encourage other nations to reassess their participation in international bodies, potentially reshaping the future dynamics of global health governance in an increasingly fragmented world order.

Delhi CM Shares Plan To Integrate Style Super Medical Hub

IITM Bureau

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday (March 16 2026) proposed integrating Guru Teg Bahadur Hospital, Delhi State Cancer Institute, and Rajiv Gandhi Super Speciality Hospital into a single “super medical hub” modelled on the lines of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS). In her post on X, CM Gupta said, “GTB Hospital, Delhi State Cancer Institute, and Rajiv Gandhi Super Speciality Hospital are being integrated and developed into a super medical hub on the lines of AIIMS. This will increase bed availability, simplify the process of tests and referrals, and reduce waiting times so that every patient can

receive timely, fast, and better treatment.” Earlier on Sunday, she had highlighted the broader vision for Delhi’s public healthcare system. “Major government medical institutions in Delhi, such as Guru Teg Bahadur Hospital (GTB), Delhi State Cancer Institute (DSCI), and Rajiv Gandhi Super Speciality Hospital (RGSSH), are being integrated and developed into an autonomous and empowered institution on the lines of AIIMS. This will enable millions of patients from Delhi and surrounding areas to access better, modern, and specialised medical facilities at one place. “The quality of treatment will improve, services will become more streamlined, and



high-level healthcare will become more accessible to the general public than before. This step is a significant initiative towards a strong and reliable healthcare system in Delhi.” The proposed integration comes as part of the government’s efforts to address the uneven distribution of patients. For instance, Rajiv Gandhi Super Speciality Hospital, with a sanctioned capacity of about 650 beds, currently operates only around 250 beds, leaving nearly 400 beds unused. In contrast, Guru Teg Ba-

hadur Hospital, which has a sanctioned capacity of approximately 1,400 beds, is currently handling over 1,500 patients due to heavy demand. By consolidating these three key hospitals into a single integrated medical institute, the Delhi government aims to ensure better coordination, optimal use of resources, and more streamlined patient care. The move is expected to reduce waiting times, improve access to specialised treatment, and create a modern healthcare hub.

Govt Expands Tribal Healthcare Access Under National Health Mission With Relaxed Norms

Dr. Rajnesh Kumar Pandey

Marking World Tuberculosis Day, India on Tuesday (March 25 2026) launched a first-of-its-kind global clinical study to scientifically evaluate the integration of Ayurveda with standard tuberculosis treatment, in a major step towards achieving a TB-free nation. Announcing the initiative, Union Minister Jitendra Singh described the study as a unique convergence of modern biotechnology and traditional knowledge systems aimed at improving treatment outcomes through a holistic and pa-

tient-centric approach. The study will assess Ayurveda as an adjunct to standard Anti-Tuberculosis Treatment (ATT), with participation of over 1,200 patients across leading institutions in the country. It seeks to evaluate outcomes such as nutritional recovery, body weight, disease progression, quality of life, safety, and treatment tolerability. Highlighting India's progress, Singh noted that the country has recorded a 21% decline in tuberculosis incidence since 2015, with cases dropping to around 187 per 100,000 pop-

ulations in 2024. He attributed the progress to sustained innovation, early diagnosis, and strengthened patient-centric care under the National TB Elimination Programme. “Modern science and traditional knowledge must come together for holistic management and better outcomes in tuberculosis,” the minister said, stressing that TB treatment must go beyond curing infection to ensuring complete recovery and improved quality of life. Despite advances in treatment, TB continues to pose challenges such as drug resis-



for a comprehensive healthcare approach. The study, collaboration between the Department of Biotechnology and the Ministry of Ayush, aims to scientifically validate traditional medicine through rigorous research. It reflects a “whole-of-science”

and “whole-of-government” approach, combining expertise across sectors. The research will also leverage advanced tools such as immune profiling, metabolomics, MRI, and genomic analysis to understand the impact of integrative therapies on recovery and

long-term outcomes. India has been expanding its TB research efforts through initiatives such as genomic surveillance and large-scale cohort studies. Programmes like REPORT India and the Indian Tuberculosis Genomic Surveillance Consortium have contributed to global policy frameworks and strengthened the country's response to drug-resistant TB. The government has also been investing in diagnostics, vaccine development, and digital adherence technologies to accelerate TB elimination efforts. Emphasising the role

of society, Singh said tuberculosis cannot be tackled by the government alone and requires active participation from communities, civil society, and individuals to eliminate stigma and ensure early diagnosis. He stressed that awareness, nutrition, and community support are critical components of recovery, alongside medical treatment. Collective responsibility, sustained funding, innovation, and compassionate care will strengthen India's mission to eliminate tuberculosis and ensure healthier communities nationwide.

Kritika Kamra's Wedding Entry Sparks Emotional Moment for Gaurav Kapur

IITM Bureau

Actor Kritika Kamra and television presenter Gaurav Kapur's intimate wedding ceremony has become one of the most talked-about entertainment stories after a heartfelt video from their special day went viral on social media.

The video captured an emotional moment in which Gaurav Kapur broke down in tears as Kritika made her bridal entry, leaving fans deeply moved. The couple tied the knot on March 11, 2026, in a private and elegant ceremony held at their Bandra residence in Mumbai in the presence of close friends and family members. Unlike a grand celebrity wed-

ding, the event was simple, intimate, and deeply personal, which has been widely appreciated by fans and the entertainment fraternity alike. The viral wedding vows video begins with Gaurav speaking candidly about the significance of the day and the joy of celebrating their union with loved ones. As Kritika walked down the aisle in a graceful bridal ensemble, Gaurav was seen getting visibly emotional and wiping away tears. The touching moment quickly became the highlight of the video and spread rapidly across social media platforms. During the exchange of vows, the couple shared heartfelt promises with



each other. One of the most emotional lines from the ceremony was Gaurav's assurance to Kritika: "I've got your back forever." The statement resonated strongly with viewers and fans, who praised the couple for their genuine bond and emotional honesty. Social media users described the video as "wholesome" and "heart-melting," with

many congratulating the newlyweds and appreciating the simplicity of the ceremony. Clips from the wedding have continued to trend online, making it one of the major entertainment highlights of March 2026 in India. The emotional wedding video has once again highlighted the popularity of Kritika Kamra and Gaurav Kapur, whose heartfelt

celebration of love has captured the attention of audiences across the country. The couple's wedding has also sparked conversations about redefining celebrity celebrations, proving that authenticity and emotional connection matter more than extravagance. Fans continue to share clips, quotes, and heartfelt messages on digital platforms.

Dhurandhar 2 box office collection: Ranveer Singh film records Rs 260 crore+ worldwide in pre-sales

IITM Bureau

Ranveer Singh-starrer Dhurandhar 2: The Revenge has generated extraordinary excitement at the box office even before its official release, with worldwide advance bookings for the opening weekend reportedly crossing the 260 crore gross mark. The impressive figures have made the film one of the biggest pre-release performers in Indian cinema, indicating an overwhelming response from audiences in both domestic and international markets. According to trade estimates shared by Sacnilk on March 19, 2026, the film's opening weekend pre-sales have surpassed 260 crore globally, setting a



new benchmark for advance ticket bookings. The strong numbers reflect the massive anticipation surrounding the sequel and highlight the star power of Ranveer Singh, whose fan base has shown remarkable enthusiasm for the film. Industry experts believe that the advance booking trend points towards a record-breaking opening weekend. The trade report suggests that Dhurandhar 2 has already created history with

its advance sales and is heading towards release with exceptional momentum. The film has become one of the most talked-about releases of the year, with cinema halls reporting high occupancy rates for the initial shows. A significant contribution to the pre-sales has come from overseas markets. International advance bookings alone have reportedly crossed the 100 crore gross mark. Key territories such as North

America, the United Kingdom, the Middle East, and Australia have shown strong demand, further boosting the film's worldwide collections even before release. Trade analysts note that these figures are significant not only because of their sheer size but also because they indicate the film's potential to achieve a blockbuster opening. The strong advance sales suggest that Dhurandhar 2 may set new box office records in its first weekend and possibly emerge as one of the highest-grossing films of the year. With such historic pre-sales numbers, all eyes are now on the film's release and its performance at the global box office

Rashmika Mandanna, Vijay Deverakonda Receive Grand Welcome in His Hometown

IITM Bureau

Popular actors Rashmika Mandanna and Vijay Deverakonda received a massive and heartwarming welcome in the actor's hometown shortly after their wedding, drawing huge crowds and widespread attention on social media. The newly married couple visited Vijay's native village on March 2, 2026, Thummanpet in Telangana, where hundreds of fans and local residents gathered to catch a glimpse of the stars. The visit turned into a celebratory event as villagers welcomed the couple with great enthusiasm and traditional fervour. Videos and photographs from the event quickly went viral online, showing large crowds cheer-



ing for the couple and showering them with love and blessings. The atmosphere was festive, with people eagerly waiting to see the newlyweds. One of the key highlights of the visit was Rashmika Mandanna greeting the crowd from a stage set up in the village. Dressed in elegant traditional attire, the actress was seen waving at the fans, smiling warmly, and folding her hands in gratitude. She also bowed respectfully towards the crowd, acknowledging

the overwhelming reception. Vijay Deverakonda stood beside her, equally delighted by the warm response from his hometown. According to reports, the couple had visited the village to participate in traditional family rituals, including a Satyanarayana puja following their wedding. Their presence added a festive spirit to the occasion, making it a memorable moment for the local residents and fans alike. The grand reception reflects the

immense popularity of both actors, whose on-screen chemistry and off-screen bond have made them one of the most talked-about celebrity couples in the country. Their visit to the hometown has further strengthened their connection with fans, especially in Telangana and the Telugu film industry. Social media platforms were flooded with clips and pictures from the event, with fans praising the couple's humility and grace. The grand welcome has once again highlighted the massive fan following enjoyed by Rashmika Mandanna and Vijay Deverakonda, turning their hometown visit into one of the major entertainment headlines of the month.

After 'Toxic,' Adivi Sesh's 'Dacoit' postponed to April 10: Film industry fears clash with 'Dhurandhar: The Revenge'

IITM Bureau

The much-awaited Ranveer Singh-starrer Dhurandhar: The Revenge is all set to hit theatres on March 19, and the film has already created significant buzz among cinema lovers across the country. In a major development ahead of its release, the much-anticipated box office clash has eased as actor Adivi Sesh's film Dacoit has now been postponed. Earlier, Dacoit was also scheduled for release on March 19, setting the stage for

an exciting clash at the box office. However, actor Adivi Sesh recently announced through social media that the film's release date has been shifted to April 10. The actor shared a new poster of the film with the revised release date prominently displayed. Along with the poster, Adivi Sesh wrote in the caption, "Goldfish on April 10, in cinemas worldwide," confirming the postponement of the film. The announcement quickly drew attention from fans and trade analysts, who had been closely



watching the March release calendar. This is the second major film to move away from the March 19 release window. Earlier, KGF star Yash's highly anticipated film Toxic was also scheduled to re-

lease on the same date. However, the makers decided to postpone it just two weeks before its release, reportedly to avoid a major box office clash and to ensure a better release window. With both Toxic and Dacoit step-

ping away from the date, Dhurandhar: The Revenge now enjoys a solo release, which is expected to significantly boost its box office prospects. Trade experts believe that the absence of major competing releases could help the film secure a strong opening weekend and maximize its collections. Starring Ranveer Singh in a lead role, Dhurandhar: The Revenge is among the most awaited films of the year and has already generated tremendous excitement among audiences. With a clear release

window now in place, the film is expected to open to packed theatres and strong collections when it releases on March 19. Adding to the anticipation, the film's promotional campaign has been aggressive and strategically planned, with teaser clips, posters, and behind-the-scenes glimpses circulating widely across social media platforms. Fans have particularly praised Ranveer Singh's intense look and powerful screen presence, hinting at a performance that could stand out as one of his

career highlights. Industry insiders suggest that advance bookings are likely to open on a strong note, especially in metropolitan cities where the actor enjoys a massive fan following. Moreover, the film's genre, reportedly a high-octane action drama with emotional depth, has further heightened curiosity among viewers. If early reactions and pre-release buzz are any indication, Dhurandhar: The Revenge could emerge as one of the biggest box office successes of 2026, setting

the tone for upcoming releases in the year. Additionally, the film's music and background score are expected to play a crucial role in enhancing the cinematic experience. With strong word-of-mouth potential and minimal competition, the film could sustain momentum beyond its opening weekend, further solidifying its position as a major commercial entertainer. Early reviews will ultimately determine its long-term success, but expectations remain exceptionally high across trade circles and fans alike.

BCCI Announces India Men’s Home Season Schedule For 2026-27

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The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) on Thursday (March 26 2026) announced the complete schedule for the senior men’s team’s international home season for 2026–27, revealing an extensive calendar featuring 22 matches across 17 cities. The upcoming season promises to be an exciting one for cricket fans across the country, with a mix of formats and high-profile contests lined up. One of the key highlights of the schedule is the significant number of One Day Internationals (ODIs), with star



players Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma expected to feature prominently. The celebrated duo is likely to play as many as 18 ODIs over the next 12 months, making the white-ball fixtures particularly significant for fans and selectors alike. The schedule also underlines the BCCI’s continued effort to take international cricket

et to diverse venues. Matches will be held across 17 cities, ensuring wider regional representation and giving fans from different parts of the country an opportunity to witness top-level cricket. A major highlight of the announcement is the inclusion of Guwahati’s Barsapara Stadium in the prestigious Border-Gavaskar

Trophy series between India and Australia in 2027. The venue, which hosted a Test match against South Africa in November last year, continues to gain prominence on the international cricketing map. The upcoming India-Australia clash at Barsapara is expected to draw significant attention and enthusiasm from cricket followers.

The home season will not only serve as crucial preparation for upcoming international tournaments but also provide a platform for both experienced players and emerging talents to showcase their skills. With a balanced mix of Tests, ODIs, and T20 matches, the schedule reflects a comprehensive approach to team building and performance. Overall, the announcement signals an action-packed cricketing year ahead, with fans eagerly anticipating high-intensity matches and memorable performances from India’s top players.

Hockey India Sub Jr. Women National championship to begin in Ranchi on April 1

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The 16th Hockey India Sub Junior Women National Championship 2026 is scheduled to start on April 1 in Ranchi, Jharkhand. It will continue until April 12 and will feature a division-based format, a competitive structure introduced by Hockey India across national championships last year.

Division ‘A’ consists of 12 teams split into four pools. The knockout rounds start on April 9 and conclude with the Final on April 12. Hockey Jharkhand, the host, leads Pool A, joined by Bihar

(BSSA) and Hockey Bengal, and Assam Hockey. Pool B consists of Hockey Chandigarh, Hockey Uttarakhand, Hockey Gujarat, Hockey Karnataka, and Hockey Himachal. Division ‘C’ will be held in a league format from April 1-4. Pool A features Kerala Hockey, Telangana Hockey, and Goans Hockey, whereas Pool B includes Hockey Jammu & Kashmir, Le Puducherry Hockey, RAJ, and Tripura Olympic Association.

Matches will take place at the Marang Gomke Jaipal Singh & Diu Hockey, Astro turf Hockey Stadium in Ranchi.

India Script History with Stunning Victory to Capture T20 World Cup Crown

IITM Bureau

India exorcised the demons of 2023, when they had lost the ODI World Cup final at the very stadium, as they defeated the Black Caps by 96 runs. It culminated a brilliant run at the tournament, as India has lost just one match in the last two T20 World Cups. On March 8 2026, New Zealand was blown away by the power-packed Indian batting line-up, who posted 255/5, the highest total at a T20 World Cup final. In response, the Black Caps folded at 159 in 19 over’s.



The victory ensured the final of an ICC white-ball world event. It was Sanju Samson who yet again set up the big win for India. The gulf in big-match experience was evident, as Samson and Abhishek took the attack to their rivals from the get go. India hit top gear in the

fourth over as they clobbered 24 runs in fourth over. Samson-Sharma became the first opening duo to score 50+ stand in a T20 World Cup final. A usually reliable Matt Henry ended up conceding four wides in the fifth over, contributing to eight extra deliveries New Zealand bowled in Powerplay, the most they have ever done in T20Is. Samson and Sharma carted the ball all around the park to pile 92 runs in the first six overs. It is the highest powerplay score of this World Cup, and

the joint-highest in T20 World Cup history. Though he wasn’t in the best of forms at the start of the World Cup. Sharma rose to the occasion in the final, bringing up the fastest 50 of the tournament, in just 18 balls with the help of six fours and three sixes. Ravindra provided his team the breakthrough as he had Sharma nick to the wicketkeeper. However the 98-run opening stand, with Sharma contributing 52 off 21, may have well set India up for another big score. Even after losing the

wicket, India did not let New Zealand get a toehold in the match. Samson and Ishan Kishan went hell for leather, putting on 105 runs in just 48 balls for the second wicket. Samson brought up his third half-century in a row, this time of 36 balls. It was another stunning innings by the right-hand batter, who jumped on the opportunity after returning to the playing XI. He struck five fours and eight sixes for 89 off just 46 balls. He became the third player to slam a half-century in the semi-final as well as

final of a T20 World Cup. Samson also became only the second batter, after Mahela Jayawardene in 2010, to notch three successive 80+ scores in the T20 World Cup. India’s top three were in great touch on the day, with Kishan also bringing up his half-century. With four fours and four sixes, Kishan finished at 54 off 25 balls. New Zealand’s decision to go with a pace-heavy attack in Ahmedabad back-fired. While Henry lost his composure early on, Lockie Ferguson was taken for special treatment

by the Indian batters, as the plundered 48 runs off his two overs. One James Neesham over put the brakes on India. After Samson failed to put away a full toss, Kishan and Suryakumar Yadav followed in the same over, the latter to a brilliant catch by Ravindra, as India slipped from 203/2 to 204/4 in the 16th over. After a lull in scoring, India picked up the pace yet again in the last two overs. Shivam Dube struck three fours and two sixes to plunder 24 runs off the last over and take India past the 250-mark.

Aryna Sabalenka Beats Coco Gauff In Miami Tennis Final, Completes ‘Sunshine Double’

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Defending champion Aryna Sabalenka beat hometown favourite Coco Gauff 6-2 4-6 6-3 in the Miami Open final on Saturday (March 28 2026) to join an exclusive club by completing the coveted ‘Sunshine Double’. World number one Sabalenka, who reached the final without dropping a set, won 73% of her first-serve points and faced just two break points en route to victory in a rematch of the 2025 French Open final won by Gauff. Sabalenka is only the fifth woman to win the Indian Wells and Miami titles back-to-back, a feat known as the ‘Sunshine Double’ given the tournaments’ respective locations in California and Florida. “I want to start with (Coco). You’re a fighter and you also push me so hard to be a



better player and I like our rivalry,” Sabalenka, who improved to 7-6 all-time versus Gauff, said during the trophy ceremony. Sabalenka raced out to a 2-0 lead but Gauff, from nearby Delray Beach and appearing in her first Miami final, got on the board with a love hold and then repelled three break points in her next service game to get within 3-2. But Sabalenka did not lose focus and eventually went up a double

sent a backhand wide. Sabalenka is the first player to win back-to-back Miami titles since Ashleigh Barty in 2019 and 2021. The 2020 edition was cancelled due to COVID-19. The Belarusian joins Iga Swiatek (2022), Victoria Azarenka (2016), Kim Clijsters (2005) and Steffi Graf (1994, 1996) as the only women to complete the ‘Sunshine Double’. Sabalenka also improved to 23-1 on the year, her only loss coming in the Australian Open final at the hands of Elena Rybakina, whom she went on to beat in the Indian Wells final and Miami semi-finals. “Aryna congratulations. We’ve had many battles, many finals and, yeah, I think you push me to be a better player,” said Gauff. “You’re a great fighter and hopefully we can play many more. I think we will.”

Carlos Alcaraz beats Novak Djokovic in Australian Open final to complete career grand slam

IITM Bureau

March 30 2026 Jannik Sinner defeated Jiri Lehecka 6-4, 6-4 to win the Miami Open and complete the ‘Sunshine Double’. The Italian beat Lehecka in straight sets to become the first man since Roger Federer in 2017 to win both Indian Wells and Miami in the same season. Sinner also became the first player to achieve the feat without dropping a set across the two events. The 24-year-old won Indian Wells for the first time in his career and became the eighth different man to complete the ‘Sunshine Double’. Novak Djokovic and Federer have achieved the feat multiple times. Eight men who have completed the Sunshine Double at least once are: Jim Courier (1991), Michael Chang (1992), Pete Sam-

pras (1994), Marcelo Rios (1998), Andre Agassi (2001), Roger Federer (2005-06) and Novak Djokovic (2011, 2014-16). “Doing the Double for the first time is incredible,” Sinner said in his on-court interview. “It’s something I never thought I would achieve because it’s so difficult. We somehow made it happen, so I’m very happy.” Sinner also extended his run to 34 consecutive sets won at the ATP Masters 1000 level, dating back to last year’s Paris Masters. He improved to 19-2 this season, according to the ATP Win/Loss Index. On Saturday, Aryna Sabalenka completed the ‘Sunshine Double’. Following Sinner’s triumph, it marked only the fourth time that an ATP and a WTA player have completed the Sunshine Double in the same year. The



first instance came in day’s ATP Rankings. 1994, when Sampras and Steffi Graf won both Indian Wells and Miami. In 2005, Federer and Kim Clijsters achieved the same feat, while in 2016, Djokovic and Victoria Azarenka also secured Sunshine Double glory. A seven-time ATP Masters 1000 champion, Sinner now trails World No. 1 Carlos Alcaraz by 1,190 points in the ATP Live Rankings after an impressive month. Lehecka, 24, was competing in his maiden ATP Masters 1000 final and is set to reach a career-high No. 14 in Mon-